
Sleep As Foundation

Companion Workbook — systematically optimize
the most important recovery practice you have

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

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Inner Circle Deep Cut — #8 Workbook

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Introduction

A YEAR-LONG COMPANION TO THE IC8 DEEP CUT.
Systematically optimize the most important
recovery practice you have.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

YEAR-LONG REFERENCE. SLEEP ENVIRONMENT audit first. 30-day tracker when starting optimization. Quarterly check-ins for ongoing maintenance.

Bring it to every session.

CHAPTER 2

Sleep Environment Audit

WALK THROUGH YOUR BEDROOM AND ASSESS each item honestly.

Temperature

- Current room temperature at bedtime: ____°F
- Target: 65-68°F
- Action needed: ☐ None / ☐ Lower thermostat / ☐ Fan / ☐ Open window

Light

- Room darkness: ☐ Pitch black / ☐ Mostly dark / ☐ Some ambient / ☐ Bright
- Action needed: ☐ None / ☐ Blackout curtains / ☐ Sleep mask / ☐ Cover light sources / ☐ Remove devices with displays

Sound

- Consistency: ☐ Quiet / ☐ Consistent (white noise/fan) / ☐ Variable / ☐ Loud
- Action needed: ☐ None / ☐ White noise machine / ☐ Earplugs / ☐ Address source

Pillow check

Lie on your side. Is your head in line with your spine?

- [] Yes — pillow is right
- [] Head tips DOWN — pillow too thin (add another or replace)
- [] Head tips UP — pillow too thick (replace or fold over)

Mattress check

Lie flat on your back. Slide your hand under your low back.

- [] Slides snugly — mattress is right
- [] Slides with room to wiggle — too firm (add topper)
- [] Can't fit hand — too soft (replace or use firmer surface)

Sleep position

- [] Side with pillow between knees (best)
- [] Side without pillow between knees
- [] Back with pillow under knees
- [] Back flat
- [] Stomach (consider switching)

Bed/bedroom use

- ☐ Bed is for sleep and sex only
 - ☐ Sometimes work or watch TV in bed
 - ☐ Often work, watch TV, scroll in bed
-

CHAPTER 3

Sleep Habits Audit

Caffeine

- Cut-off time: ____
- Total daily cups: ____
- Form: [☐] Coffee / [☐] Tea / [☐] Energy drinks / [☐] Pre-workout / [☐] Soda

ACTION NEEDED: _____

Alcohol

- Drinks per week: ____
- Typical evening pattern: _____

Action needed: _____

Screens

- Time of last screen use before bed: ____ min/
hours
- Phone in bedroom overnight: [☐] Yes / [☐] No
- Read paper book or screen: [☐] Paper / [☐] Screen /
[☐] Both

Action needed: _____

Schedule

- Typical bedtime: _____
- Typical wake time: _____
- Hours of sleep: _____
- Consistency (within 30 min): [☐] Daily / [☐]
Workdays / [☐] Variable

Action needed: _____

Pre-bed routine

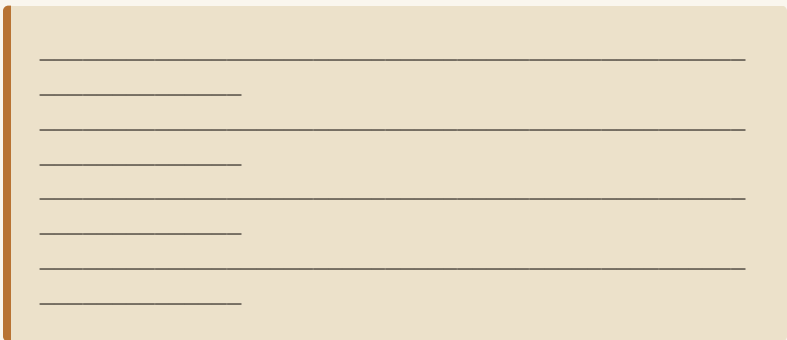
Current evening routine (be honest):

Action needed: _____

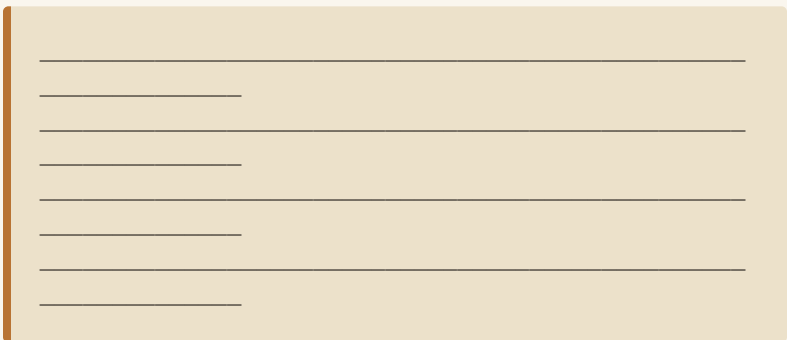
CHAPTER 4

Reflection Prompts

PROMPT 1: WHEN WAS THE LAST PERIOD OF YOUR life when you slept consistently well? What was different then about your environment, routine, or life circumstances?



Prompt 2: What's the one sleep habit you know is hurting you but you keep doing? Why? What would have to change for you to actually stop?



Prompt 3: If you slept truly well for a month — what would change in your life? What would you finally have energy for?

CHAPTER 5

Red Flag Self-Check

ANY “YES” WARRANTS MEDICAL EVALUATION
(sleep study or physician consult):

- ☐ Loud snoring
- ☐ Partner has noticed I stop breathing or gasp during sleep
- ☐ Wake with morning headaches
- ☐ Severe daytime fatigue despite adequate sleep hours
- ☐ Restless legs sensation at night
- ☐ Acting out dreams
- ☐ Cataplexy
- ☐ Sleep paralysis
- ☐ Vivid hallucinations falling asleep

If any checked — plan to talk to physician: Date:

—

CHAPTER 6

My Sleep Optimization Plan

TOP 3 CHANGES I'LL MAKE FIRST:

1.

2.

3.

My new bedtime target: ____

My new wake time target: ____

My new caffeine cut-off: ____

My new screen cut-off: ____

My pre-bed routine (10-30 min):

CHAPTER 7

30-Day Sleep Tracker

DAY	DATE	BED-TIME	WAKE	HOURS	QUAL-ITY (1-10)	RE-FRESHED?	NO
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							
11							
12							
13							
14							
15							
16							
17							

DAY	DATE	BED-TIME	WAKE	HOURS	QUAL-ITY (1-10)	RE-FRESHED?
18						
19						
20						
21						
22						
23						
24						
25						
26						
27						
28						
29						
30						

CHAPTER 8

30-Day Reflection

AVERAGE HOURS OF SLEEP (DAYS 1-7 vs 24-30):

_ → _

Average quality (Days 1-7 vs 24-30): _ → _

Days I woke refreshed (Days 1-7 vs 24-30): _ → _

What's the biggest change?

Which change made the biggest difference?

- [] Cooler room
- [] Consistent schedule
- [] Caffeine cut-off
- [] Screen cut-off
- [] Pre-bed routine
- [] Bedding change
- [] Other: _____

Recommitment for next 30 days:

CHAPTER 9

Quarterly Check-Ins

Q1 Check-In

DATE: ____

Average sleep hours past 90 days: ____

Sleep quality trend: [☐] Better / [☐] Same / [☐]
Worse than 90 days ago

Adjustments needed:

Q2, Q3, Q4 Check-Ins

Use same format. Copy/photocopy as needed.

CHAPTER 10

Year-End Sleep Inventory

COMPARED TO ONE YEAR AGO:

- Sleep hours: ☐ More / ☐ Same / ☐ Less
- Sleep quality: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Daytime energy: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Mood: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse
- Physical recovery: ☐ Better / ☐ Same / ☐ Worse

Biggest sleep-related shift this year:

Commitment for next year:

CHAPTER 11

Try this for 30 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

Phone in another room. Bed by 10:30 PM. Wake at the same time daily, including weekends. Caffeine cut off by noon. 30 days.

Don't add anything else. Just these four things.

Most people who actually do this for 30 days are shocked at how different they feel. This is the highest-leverage sleep intervention.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
LMT and published by Healing Hands By
Nate.